

Armed conflict

CONFLICT / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

If fighting or explosions are nearby, move away from windows and exposed areas into the most protective intact space you can reach safely. Keep family members together, shoes and essential medicines close, and a plan for losing phone service. Do not cross active fighting for supplies or touch suspicious debris. Assistance and safe passage may be unavailable; judge movement against the danger of staying.

Do now.

- ☐ **Choose shelter before the next attack**
01 Prefer a designated protective shelter if safely reachable. Otherwise use the most protective intact interior area available, away from glazing. Consider collapse, fire and flooding as well as blast exposure; no ordinary room guarantees safety.
- ☐ **Keep essentials beside you**
02 Gather a battery light, footwear, safe water, medicines and written contacts without exposing yourself to retrieve them. Keep corridors and exits clear.
- ☐ **Make a family check-in plan**
03 Choose nearby and out-of-area reunion contacts. Use short private messages with your location and status; do not publish live movements or other people's locations.
- ☐ **Reassess before moving**
04 Confirm a destination and route as recently as possible with independent trusted information. A claimed corridor or ceasefire is not proof of safe passage. Do not cross active fighting.
- ☐ **Avoid explosive debris**
05 Leave unfamiliar objects, wires, fragments and abandoned munitions untouched. Warn people from a safe position and use verified demining or humanitarian channels when safe.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Choose the most protective reachable room before another attack, keep footwear and a light there, and keep essential medicines close. Do not cross active fighting to collect supplies. Use verified humanitarian contacts and trusted people; government assistance or safe passage may not exist.

Watch for.

A lull is not an all-clear. Fire, damaged structures, unexploded ordnance and interrupted utilities remain dangerous. Avoid confrontation with armed personnel; local protection risks determine whether contacting officials is safe.

People & practical needs.

Choose two reunion places and an out-of-area contact. Keep children with a trusted caregiver and carry a written contact card. Share sensitive addresses and travel details only with people who need them; avoid posting live locations or images of other families without consent. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: choose shelter before the next attack. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. A lull is not an all-clear. Fire, damaged structures, unexploded ordnance and interrupted utilities remain dangerous. Avoid confrontation with armed personnel; local protection risks determine whether contacting officials is safe.

Keep essentials within reach.

For armed conflict, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Choose the most protective reachable room before another attack, keep footwear and a light there, and keep essential medicines close. Do not cross active fighting to collect supplies. Use verified humanitarian contacts and trusted people; government assistance or safe passage may not exist. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Inventory water, food, medical supplies and power for the people with you. Arrange care tasks and check-ins with trusted neighbours where safe. Verify humanitarian assistance directly; do not assume government, embassy or aid transport will arrive.

First decision: Choose shelter before the next attack

Prefer a designated protective shelter if safely reachable. Otherwise use the most protective intact interior area available, away from glazing. Consider collapse, fire and flooding as well as blast exposure; no ordinary room guarantees safety. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Choose the most protective reachable room before another attack, keep footwear and a light there, and keep essential medicines close. Do not cross active fighting to collect supplies. Use verified humanitarian contacts and trusted people; government assistance or safe passage may not exist. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

A lull is not an all-clear. Fire, damaged structures, unexploded ordnance and interrupted utilities remain dangerous. Avoid confrontation with armed personnel; local protection risks determine whether contacting officials is safe. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

If fighting or explosions are nearby, move away from windows and exposed areas into the most protective intact space you can reach safely. Keep family members together, shoes and essential medicines close, and a plan for losing phone service. Do not cross active fighting for supplies or touch suspicious debris. Assistance and safe passage may be unavailable; judge movement against the danger of staying. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For armed conflict, keep the specific hazard in view: A lull is not an all-clear. Fire, damaged structures, unexploded ordnance and interrupted utilities remain dangerous. Avoid confrontation with armed personnel; local protection risks determine whether contacting officials is safe.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Avoid explosive debris. Leave unfamiliar objects, wires, fragments and abandoned munitions untouched. Warn people from a safe position and use verified demining or humanitarian channels when safe. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[ICRC · Explosive remnants of war](#)

<https://www.icrc.org/en/law-and-policy/explosive-remnants-war>

[U.S. State Department · Crisis response](#)

<https://travel.state.gov/en/international-travel/help-abroad/crisis-response.html>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/armed-conflict/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.